

Richard Phan

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EDUCATION

Georgia Institute of Technology

B.S. Computer Science, emphasis in Artificial Intelligence

Expected Grad: May 2027

GPA: 3.76/4.00

SKILLS

Languages: *Java, Python, JavaScript, C++, HTML, SvelteKit, PowerShell, PostgreSQL, React, Go, Ruby*

Tools/Frameworks: *NumPy, TensorFlow, PyTorch, Scikit-Learn, AWS, Azure, Flask, Tech Documentation, GitHub*

Relevant Coursework: *Artificial Intelligence, Software Development, Data Science/Structures, Calc 2, Linear Algebra*

WORK EXPERIENCE

Amazon Web Services | *Software Development Engineer Intern*, Palo Alto, CA

May 2025 - Aug 2025

- Built an automation tool to streamline AWS on-call support, cutting resolution time from **6 hours to minutes** by validating requests and updating using AppConfig via Lambda and CDK
- Designed a distributed observability dashboard using Lambda + CDK to monitor 250+ data streams, **30% faster time-to-root-cause analysis**, and reduced on-call escalations by 22%
- Outlined a comprehensive design doc that compared 3 different solutions with tradeoffs and architectural diagrams

McKenney's | *Software Engineer Intern*, Atlanta, GA

May 2024 - Aug 2024

- Built and deployed **3 automation** pipelines in **Python and SQL**, boosting team efficiency by 50% for **10+ employees**
- Developed **Pandas and Google Analytics API** scripts to improve financial reporting analytics by 25%
- Led knowledge base preprocessing efforts to prepare for **Retrieval-Augmented Generation system deployment**, creating and auditing **250+ technical documents** to improve maintainability and alignment across a 25-engineer team

Verinext | *Solutions Architecture Intern*, Duluth, GA

Sep 2023 - May 2024

- Delivered tailored solutions to clients, achieving a **95% client satisfaction rate**, by consulting their needs and offering appropriate options based on budget, **infrastructure**, company size, and usage
- Acquired leads for **data analytics** solutions, with **observability**, resulting in a 40% increase in sales opportunities
- Earned Spunk Accreditation in Technical Selling Foundations (Partner) and Observability Sales Engineer I (Partner)

PROJECT EXPERIENCE

Interpretability & Deception in LLMs - AI Researcher

July 2025 - Oct 2025

- Led research on deceptive reasoning in LLMs, analyzing **internal activations** across multi-step reasoning traces to identify and map circuits linked to dishonest behavior, extending beyond traditional output-level detection
- Built on **Anthropic's CCS interpretability methods**, analyzed model activations across 1M+ parameters, isolating statistically significant neurons linked to deception behavior using regression probes, activation patching, and causal tracing, resulting in a **novel methodology** for dynamic deception auditing and AI safety

UGA Marketplace Website - *Lead Developer*

Aug 2024 - Oct 2024

- Led a team of 4 in **web application development** to develop a peer-to-peer marketplace app for UGA students, facilitating transactions by implementing a secure login system, bot prevention, Docker, and user authentication
- Implemented secure user authentication, enabling encrypted session handling and ACID-compliant payment flow

LEADERSHIP & INVOLVEMENT

Tech + UGC Content Creator - 1000+ Followers

Aug 2025 - Present

- Produced engaging User Generated Content for 3 AI startup products, reaching **400K+ cumulative views** and fostering active user communities within the creator economy

Anthropic Growth Team - *Claude Builder*

Aug 2025 - Present

- Drove **40% increase** in Claude adoption across **8 colleges** through a multi-campus Hackathon with **500 students**
- Led **50 interviews** with students and presented key takeaways to Anthropic's product and **engineering leadership**

AI @ UGA - *Founder and Co-President*

Aug 2024 - Present

- **Recruited 25 students** to partner with **5 companies** to provide AI solutions for community-based problems